NCRIC AstroMetrics user provisioning and federal access authorization (resubmitted; originally submitted 9/13/2026)

MuckRock request #222130 · San Mateo County Sheriff’s Office

Status: Awaiting Response · Submitted: 2026-09-28 · Due: 2026-10-08 (overdue per MuckRock) · Completed: 2026-11-05

Source: https://www.muckrock.com/foi/san-mateo-county-3064/ncric-astrometrics-user-provisioning-and-federal-access-authorization-resubmitted-originally-submitted-9132026-222130/

Captured 2026-11-06T02:15:49Z from MuckRock's api_v2 (raw response sha256 c747dcf00c3b72e9e62bd9d293b3380282478722726376a406787e8cda1a3385). Communication text is extracted verbatim. Redacted: requester surname (first sender's full name reduced to first name); MuckRock upload links; MuckRock request routing addresses.

From: Brian — 2026-09-28T01:05:32.064558-04:00

Subject: California Public Records Act Request: NCRIC AstroMetrics user provisioning and federal access authorization (resubmitted; originally submitted 9/13/2026)

To Whom It May Concern:

Pursuant to the California Public Records Act, I hereby request the following records:

Resubmission of an unanswered request. I submitted the request below by email to sheriffs_recordsrequest@smcgov.org on September 13, 2026; a copy of that email is attached. I have received no acknowledgment, no determination, and no notice of extension, and the 10-day period for a determination under Gov. Code § 7922.535 has passed. I am resubmitting the request through this address so that the request and all correspondence about it are kept in one place. Please process it as the same request, as of its original submission date, and not as a new request with a new response period. Please send the overdue determination, and all further correspondence, to this address. The text below is unchanged from the original. Where it says "the date of this request," that means September 13, 2026.

Pursuant to the California Public Records Act (Gov. Code § 7920.000 et seq.), I request the following records from the San Mateo County Sheriff's Office.

This request seeks existing records only (Gov. Code § 7922.530; Sierra Club v. Superior Court (2013) 57 Cal.4th 157). Each item is limited to records created on or before the date of this request.

Scope basis. The Sheriff's Office's Memorandum of Understanding with the Northern California Regional Intelligence Center ("NCRIC"), produced by the San Mateo Police Department under Public Records Act request W012376-032026, is executed by Greg Munks, Sheriff of San Mateo County, on behalf of NCRIC. To the extent the Sheriff's Office holds, creates, or retains records in an administrative or fiscal capacity for NCRIC, those records are writings "prepared, owned, used, or retained" by the Sheriff's Office within the meaning of Gov. Code § 7920.530, regardless of whether NCRIC's day-to-day IT operations are performed by NCRIC staff, a vendor, or another member agency's personnel on NCRIC's behalf. If the Sheriff's Office takes the position that it does not hold the records described below and that some other entity is the proper respondent, please identify that entity and the basis for that position in the written determination.

As you are aware, NCRIC provided ALPR data aggregation and search services to its member agencies through a platform known as "AstroMetrics," built and operated on NCRIC's behalf by MaiVERIC, Inc. MaiVERIC's November 17, 2022 press release announcing the platform's deployment quotes Brian Rodrigues, NCRIC's Assistant Deputy Director for Information Technology & Cyber Security, and states that AstroMetrics was being provided "to 70 public safety agencies" and that it "maintains all usage records" and that "[c]lient administrators also have access to real-time data ingestion and usage logs."

As you are further aware, the vendor's own published technical documentation for the

AstroMetrics platform states that NCRIC used a third-party identity provider, SecureAuth, configured to authenticate users against NCRIC's own internal Active Directory, and that users were federated into the AstroMetrics application through that mechanism — an identity realm the documentation identifies as "SecureAuth5" — rather than through any login screen operated by the vendor. That same documentation reflects that non-NCRIC personnel, including accounts associated with federal agency domains, accessed the platform through this mechanism during at least the period June through December 2023.

Civil Code § 1798.90.52 provides that an ALPR operator that accesses, or provides access to, ALPR information shall maintain a record of that access including the date and time of access, the data elements used to query the system, the username of the person accessing the information, and, as applicable, the organization or entity with which that person is affiliated, and the purpose for accessing the information. As the entity that operated AstroMetrics and provided its member agencies' and other users' access to ALPR information through that platform, NCRIC is an ALPR operator within the meaning of that section as to the records described below.

Records requested, from January 1, 2021 through the date of this request:

1. Records reflecting the population of user accounts provisioned for the AstroMetrics platform (or its predecessor or successor NCRIC ALPR aggregation platform, by whatever name), by agency or organizational affiliation — including any roster, directory export, account listing, or periodic user-count report, at any point during the period covered by this request.

2. Records describing or reflecting the process by which a person or account not affiliated with an NCRIC member agency — including any person or account affiliated with a federal agency or department — was granted an AstroMetrics account, added to NCRIC's Active Directory, or federated into AstroMetrics access through the SecureAuth identity provider or any successor identity provider.

3. Any agreement, memorandum, authorization, policy, or correspondence permitting or addressing access by any federal agency or department, or by any of its personnel or contractors, to ALPR information contributed by NCRIC member agencies, whether through AstroMetrics or any other NCRIC-operated or NCRIC-affiliated system.

4. SecureAuth or Active Directory logs, reports, or exports reflecting user account creation, modification, or deletion events, and user authentication (login) events, for the identity realm bound to the AstroMetrics application (identified in the vendor's documentation as "SecureAuth5"), for the full period such logs exist.

5. Records reflecting NCRIC's or the Sheriff's Office's access to, or possession of, the access records described in Item 1 of the request captioned "NCRIC platform access data and its disposition" submitted to the San Mateo Police Department, to the extent responsive records exist independent of anything SMPD may produce.

If no records are located for any individual item, please respond to that item separately and continue processing the remaining items.

If any portion of this request is denied, please identify the specific record withheld, state the specific statutory exemption relied upon, and produce all reasonably segregable non-exempt portions (Gov. Code §§ 7922.000, 7922.525). If any item is denied on the ground that the Sheriff's Office does not hold the responsive records in its NCRIC-administrative capacity, please identify the entity that does and the basis for that position.

Please provide the determination required by Government Code § 7922.535 within 10 days, in writing, per § 7922.540. Please acknowledge receipt of this request so the record reflects the date received.

The requested documents will be made available to the general public, and this request is not being made for commercial purposes.

In the event that there are fees, I would be grateful if you would inform me of the total charges in advance of fulfilling my request. I would prefer the request filled electronically, by e-mail attachment if available or CD-ROM if not.

Thank you in advance for your anticipated cooperation in this matter. I look forward to receiving your response to this request within 10 calendar days, as the statute requires.

Sincerely,

Brian

Attachments: 72_smcso_astrometrics_pra_2026-09-13.pdf

From: Muckrock Staff — 2026-10-08T01:00:50.453880-04:00

Subject: RE: California Public Records Act Request: NCRIC AstroMetrics user provisioning and federal access authorization (resubmitted; originally submitted 9/13/2026)

To Whom It May Concern:

I wanted to follow up on the following California Public Records Act request, copied below, and originally submitted on Sept. 28, 2026. Please let me know when I can expect to receive a response.

Thanks for your help, and let me know if further clarification is needed.

From: San Mateo County Sheriff’s Office — 2026-10-08T14:53:30.966243-04:00

Subject: RE: California Public Records Act Request: NCRIC AstroMetrics user provisioning and federal access authorization (resubmitted; originally submitted 9/13/2026)

Good morning,

The Sheriff’s Office does not have any responsive documents for this request.
Regards,
Jen

Jennifer Prado, Criminal Records Manager
San Mateo County Sheriff’s Office
Criminal Records Bureau
330 Bradford Street
Redwood City, CA 94063

Attachments: image001

From: Brian — 2026-10-09T00:06:01.833750-04:00

Subject: RE: California Public Records Act Request: NCRIC AstroMetrics user provisioning and federal access authorization (resubmitted; originally submitted 9/13/2026)

Ms. Prado,

Thank you for the response. For the record, this request was first submitted by email to sheriffs_recordsrequest@smcgov.org on September 13, 2026, and resubmitted here on September 28. MuckRock's automated October 8 follow-up gives only the September 28 date. Your October 8 response is the first communication I have received from the Sheriff's Office about this request.

The request was addressed to the Sheriff's Office, including in any administrative or fiscal capacity it has for NCRIC. The County of San Mateo purchase orders for the AstroMetrics platform, P2203165 (April 13, 2022) and P2304292 (June 14, 2023), which NCRIC produced on September 25, 2026, are billed to "COUNTY OF SAN MATEO, pony SHF112" and shipped to Northern California HIDTA. If the search did not already include them, please extend it to records held by the Sheriff's Office staff or units that carry out NCRIC or Northern California HIDTA administrative and fiscal functions. Item 3 in particular asks for agreements, authorizations and correspondence, which are the kind of records an administrative office keeps.

Please also give the determination for each of items 1 through 5 separately, as the request asked. If the Sheriff's Office understands any of these records to be held by

NCRIC, Northern California HIDTA, or another entity, please identify that entity, as the request also asked.

Thank you.

From: San Mateo County Sheriff's Office — 2026-10-19T11:15:44.289394-04:00

Subject: RE: California Public Records Act Request: NCRIC AstroMetrics user provisioning and federal access authorization (resubmitted; originally submitted 9/13/2026)

Good morning,

This is to confirm receipt of your follow up. I apologize as I was out of the office all last week. I will follow up on your questions and you should receive a response by early next week.

Jen

Jennifer Prado, Criminal Records Manager
San Mateo County Sheriff's Office
Criminal Records Bureau
330 Bradford Street
Redwood City, CA 94063

Attachments: image001

From: Muckrock Staff — 2026-11-03T01:00:41.706672-05:00

Subject: RE: California Public Records Act Request: NCRIC AstroMetrics user provisioning and federal access authorization (resubmitted; originally submitted 9/13/2026)

To Whom It May Concern:

I wanted to follow up on the following California Public Records Act request, copied below, and originally submitted on Sept. 28, 2026. Please let me know when I can expect to receive a response.

Thanks for your help, and let me know if further clarification is needed.

From: San Mateo County Sheriff's Office — 2026-11-05T11:46:36.146641-05:00

Subject: RE: California Public Records Act Request: NCRIC AstroMetrics user provisioning and federal access authorization (resubmitted; originally submitted 9/13/2026)

Good morning,

NCRIC has provided four County purchase orders – two for Astrometrics, two for Maiveric. Attached is a copy of the NCRIC ALPR Policy, which is responsive to #3 in stating that we do not share or provide access to federal agencies or any agencies outside California.

NCRIC has no documents responsive to items 1, 2, 4, or 5; NCRIC's business with MaiVERIC/ Astrometrics concluded in 2023 and no records of users or user activity, audit logs, user lists, records of account provisioning or deprovisioning, metrics on the datastore, or any other documents related to the project, are available at this time.
Regards,
Jen

Jennifer Prado, Criminal Records Manager
San Mateo County Sheriff's Office
Criminal Records Bureau
330 Bradford Street
Redwood City, CA 94063

Attachments: image001, NCRIC-ALPR-POLICY-2024, PRA Response

From: Brian — 2026-11-05T19:59:39.894905-05:00

Subject: RE: California Public Records Act Request: NCRIC AstroMetrics user provisioning and federal access authorization (resubmitted; originally submitted 9/13/2026)

Ms. Prado,

Thank you for the November 5 response, and for routing the request to NCRIC. Please share this follow-up with NCRIC as well. It concerns Items 1 through 4.

Item 3. The response produced NCRIC's 2024 ALPR Policy and describes it as stating that NCRIC does not share or provide access to federal agencies or any agencies outside California. The request covers January 1, 2021 through September 13, 2026, and more than three years of that period precede the 2024 policy. For that earlier period, NCRIC's published ALPR policy was the version posted at https://ncric.ca.gov/wp-content/uploads/2021/10/NCRIC-ALPR-Policy.pdf. That policy states that NCRIC uses ALPR technology "[t]o support authorized law enforcement and public safety purposes of local, state, federal, and tribal public safety agencies," and, under "Dissemination," that "[t]he NCRIC may disseminate ALPR data to any governmental entity with an authorized law enforcement or public safety purpose for access to such data." It addresses access by federal agencies and is responsive to Item 3. The 2024 policy attributes its narrower rule to "California Senate Bill 34, California Senate Bill 54, and recent guidance from the California Attorney General." Senate Bill 34 has been in effect since January 1, 2016.

Under Item 3, please produce the earlier policy and any other version of NCRIC's ALPR policy in effect between January 1, 2021 and the adoption of the 2024 policy, together with any memorandum, authorization, or correspondence addressing access by federal agencies in connection with the revision that produced the 2024 policy. As the request noted, the vendor's published documentation reflects that accounts associated with federal agency domains accessed the platform during at least June through December 2023. If NCRIC holds no record under Items 2 and 3 other than its policies, that would mean it has no record of how, or on whose authority, those accounts were given access.

Items 1, 2 and 4. The response states that no records of users or user activity, audit logs, user lists, or records of account provisioning or deprovisioning "are available at this time." Government Code § 7922.535(a) calls for notice of "the determination and the reasons therefor." The response does not say whether responsive records existed on September 13, 2026, the date of the request, or, if records existed and are no longer held, when and how that changed. For each of Items 1, 2 and 4, please state whether NCRIC held responsive records on September 13, 2026. If records responsive to an item existed at any time after January 1, 2021 and are no longer held, please state when and how they were disposed of and the authority for their disposal.

Three records bear on this. First, the Memorandum of Understanding cited in the request provides: "An audit log will be maintained for a period of no less than three years to record user access to shared data, including the name and organization of the user accessing via the NCRIC-DSP and the date and time when the data was accessed." Second, NCRIC's earlier ALPR policy provides that "[a]ccess to, and use of, ALPR Data is logged for audit purposes" and that "[a]udit reports will be provided periodically and on request to supervisory personnel at the NCRIC and partner agencies"; the 2024 policy produced with the response contains the same first sentence. Third, on September 17, 2026, the San Mateo Police Department relayed to me a statement it attributes to NCRIC's Assistant Deputy Director, which says that "[a]ll searches of the data were logged for audit purposes" and that "[a]n audit log file spanning June – November 2023 contains six entries of queries by San Mateo Police Department, including the officer's email address, plate searched, and associated case number."

The file that statement describes is a record of user activity on the platform. It identifies users by email address, so it reflects the user accounts provisioned for the platform and their affiliations, and it is responsive to Item 1. NCRIC used it to prepare that statement, and Government Code § 7920.530 defines public records to include any writing "prepared, owned, used, or retained by any state or local agency." Please produce that file in the form NCRIC reviewed it for the statement. If NCRIC no longer holds it, please say so for that file specifically and state when NCRIC ceased to hold it.

Item 4 asks for logs from NCRIC's own identity systems. As the request described, the

vendor's documentation states that NCRIC's SecureAuth identity provider authenticated users against NCRIC's own Active Directory. The response explains that NCRIC's business with MaiVERIC concluded in 2023, but it does not say whether NCRIC searched its own SecureAuth and Active Directory systems, which are not vendor systems. Please state whether those systems were searched.

While these items remain open, please preserve the records they concern, including the June – November 2023 audit log file and any copy of it. By the Memorandum's terms, entries from November 2023 remain within its three-year period until November 2026. Given that timing, I would appreciate the determination for each item by Monday, November 16, 2026.

Thank you.